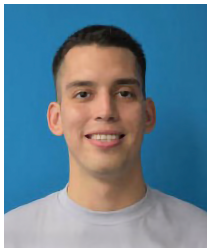
Renato Vassallo



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EDUCATION

Barcelona School of Economics — **Barcelona, Spain**
Master of Science, Data Science for Decision Making. GPA: 8.61/10 — 09/2022 - 08/2023
Achieved high marks in: *Forecasting with text as data* (8.5), *Text Mining and Natural Speech Processing* (9.4), *Machine Learning and Causal Inference* (9.6), and the *Master's Thesis* (10).

Pontifical Catholic University of Peru — **Lima, Peru**
Master's degree, Economics. Merit-based scholarship, GPA: 14.0/20 — 08/2018 - 08/2021
Thesis published on *Economic Modelling* (Q1 Scopus/Web of Science). Available here.

Universidad de Piura — **Piura, Peru**
Bachelor's degree, Economics. Top 3, GPA: 14.2/20 — 03/2012 - 12/2016

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

EconAI — **Barcelona, Spain**
Data Scientist — 11/2023 - Present
- Developing risk forecast across multiple dimensions of fragility. My focus is on forecasting economic crises and institutional disruptions using NLP and Machine Learning algorithms.

Barcelona School of Economics — **Barcelona, Spain**
Teaching Assistant — 09/2023 - 12/2023
- On the Foundations of Econometrics course for Prof. Maite Cabeza-Gutés. Responsible for teaching Stata, R and Python, reinforcing theoretical concepts and grading problem sets.

Research Assistant — 08/2023 - 11/2023
- Development of machine learning-based forecasting methods to assist Prof. Hannes Mueller (BSE) and Prof. Christian Fons-Rosen (UC Merced) in a data science research.

Lambda Group Peru — **Lima, Peru**
Lecturer in Applied Macroeconometrics — 09/2020 - Present
- Advanced Times Series Econometrics. Bayesian methods to estimate Vector Autorregresive Models (BVAR, TVP-VAR-SV). Semi-structural Modeling and Kalman Filtering.

Fiscal Council of Peru — **Lima, Peru**
Macroeconomics Specialist — 01/2018 - 09/2022
- Analysis of global economic conditions and its effects on domestic fluctuations. Estimation and monitoring of key unobservable variables. Macroeconomic forecasting and risk scenarios evaluation.
- Document drafting, presentations for senior management and participation in official documents.
- Achievements: publication of 3 working papers, 2 discussion notes, and several technical reports.

Central Reserve Bank of Peru — **Lima, Peru**
Internship - Advanced Economics Program — 01/2016 - 04/2016
- Main courses: Monetary Policy, Forecasting Methods and Evaluation, Dynamic Macroeconomics, Behavioral Economics. The courses were taught by PhD. Professors with international trajectory.

LANGUAGES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Language skills: Spanish (Native), English (Fluent).
Technical skills: Matlab, Python, R, EViews, Stata, Latex, Office; all at a professional level.
IMF Courses: Monetary Policy Analysis, Macroeconometric Forecasting, Programming and Financial Policies.

PUBLICATIONS

Forecasting Global Refugee Flows: a ML Approach using Non-Conventional Data (link).
Barcelona School of Economics, 08/2023.

Measuring Potential Output after COVID-19: an Extended Multivariate Filter (link).
Fiscal Council of Peru, 08/2023.

Effects of external shocks on macroeconomic fluctuations in Pacific Alliance countries (link).
Economic Modelling, 07/2023.

Business confidence and private investment in Peru: a non-linear analysis (link).
Fiscal Council of Peru, 03/2023.

Impact of External Shocks on the Peruvian Economy: a TVP-VAR-SV approach (link).
Fiscal Council of Peru, 05/2021.

CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

INFORM Warning Co-Design Workshop **Ispra, Italy**
Joint Research Centre (JRC) - European Commission 05/2024
- Invited to present the Conflict Forecast Project on behalf of the EconAI team. The workshop brought together experts in Early Warning Systems, humanitarian aid, and crisis anticipation.